

Recipe by
Plated

Carne Asada Sopes with Avocado-Corn Salsa and Refried Black Beans

If you're a fan of Mexican street food, the *sope* should be on your radar. The traditional specialty features masa (corn flour dough) shaped into small "bowls," perfect for holding in a variety of savory toppings. Here, they're baked in the oven rather than the typical frying method, then topped with thin strips of marinated steak, plus a bright avocado-corn salsa tossed with tomato and chopped red onion. Sprinkled with crumbly queso fresco and fresh cilantro, these colorful, easily customizable bites are packed with layers of flavor.

4
Servings

45 mins
Total cook time

Intermediate
Skill level

$48.85
$12.21 per serving

Questions?

Main Ingredients

- 1 pint grape tomatoes
- 2 avocados
- 1/4 ounce cilantro
- 3 limes
- 4 cloves garlic
- 2 red onions
- 4 steaks
- 1 teaspoon ancho chile powder
- 2 teaspoons ground cumin
- 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- 1 teaspoon dried Mexican oregano
- 1 teaspoon onion powder
- 2 teaspoons sweet paprika
- 1 teaspoon crushed red pepper
- 1 15-ounce can black beans
- 2 cups masa harina
- 1 cup corn
- 1/3 cup queso fresco
- olive oil
- kosher salt
- black pepper

Cooking Instructions

Step 1

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse and halve **tomatoes**. Halve **avocados** and discard pits. Using a spoon, carefully scoop out flesh, discarding skins. Cut into .5-inch pieces. Place in a medium bowl. Rinse **cilantro**; roughly chop leaves, discarding stems. Halve **2 limes**. Quarter **remaining lime**. Mince **garlic**. Peel **onion** and cut into small dice. Pat **steaks** dry and rub with **half of spice mix**, **1 teaspoon salt**, and **pepper**. Set aside.

Step 2

Add **tomatoes**, **half of cilantro**, **juice of 2 limes**, **.5 cup diced onion**, **1 tablespoon olive oil**, **.25 teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** to bowl with avocado, stir to combine, and set aside. Rub 2 baking sheets with **1 tablespoon olive oil** each. In a separate medium bowl, combine **masa harina** and **.5 teaspoon salt**. Slowly stir in **1.33 cups water** until fully incorporated. Using your hands, knead **dough** until smooth and holds together.

Step 3

Using your hands, form **dough** into 8 equal balls, then flatten each to form a smooth disk, about .25-inch thick. Divide **doughs** between prepared baking sheets. Working 1 at a time, pinch and crimp edges all the way around to form a .5-inch rim (the sopes should resemble small pie dishes). Rub **sopes** all over with **olive oil** and bake until lightly browned, 18-20 minutes. Then, remove from oven, sprinkle with **salt**, and divide among serving plates.

Step 4

While sopes bake, heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a small pot over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **remaining onion**. Cook until soft, 5 minutes. Add **garlic** and **remaining spice mix**. Cook, stirring, until fragrant, 1 minute. Add **beans** and **.5 cup water**. Increase heat to high. Bring to a boil. Reduce heat to medium. Cook, stirring, until thick, 15-17 minutes. Remove from heat. Using a fork, mash until smooth. Stir in **.75 teaspoon salt** and **pepper** to combine.

Step 5

While beans cook, heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **corn**. Cook until lightly browned, 2-3 minutes, then transfer to bowl with salsa. Stir to combine. Heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** in pan from corn over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **steaks**. Sear until browned and medium rare, 4-5 minutes per side. Transfer **steaks** to a cutting board. Set aside to rest, about 5 minutes.

Step 6

Once steaks have rested, cut against the grain into .25-inch slices (see Recipe Tip). Top **sopes** on serving plates with **refried beans**, then **corn salsa**, then **steak**. Garnish with **queso fresco** and **remaining cilantro** and serve with **lime wedges** for squeezing over. Dig in!

All recipe ingredients should be cooked to a safe internal temperature according to USDA guidelines. After preparing a recipe, please store any leftovers in the refrigerator.

Questions?